

The Honourable Society of the Middle Temple

No. 131

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

April 2026

The Middle Temple is one of four Inns of Court in London. It can call people to become barristers in England and Wales and helps train and support them throughout their careers.

It began in the 1300s on land once owned by the Knights Templar. By the 1400s, it was already training law students through study, practice, and shared meals. Its position near London and Westminster made it an important place for law and learning.

A new Hall was built in 1573 and became its centre. The Inn declined during the English Civil War, but legal education grew again in the 1800s.

In 1919, Helena Normanton became the first woman admitted to Middle Temple.

The Inn was badly damaged in World War II but restored by 1949. Today, it still trains barristers and its Hall remains at its heart.

